

User Guide: Farmer

This guide explains how to use the platform as a **Farmer**: posting produce, managing orders, booking pickups, and viewing analytics.

1. Logging in

- 1. Open the platform in your browser and go to **Login**.
- 2. Enter your **phone** (or email) and **password**.
- 3. Click **Sign in**. You are taken to your dashboard or **Buyer Requests** (marketplace view).

2. Main menu and navigation

After login, the sidebar shows:

Menu item	Path / Purpose
Buyer Requests	View buyer demand / marketplace as a farmer
Inputs	Browse and order farm inputs (seeds, etc.)
My Produce	Post and manage your produce listings
Pickup Schedules	View and book pickup slots at aggregation centres
Orders	List and manage orders from buyers
Analytics	View your sales and activity metrics

Use the **menu icon** on small screens to open or close the sidebar.

3. Posting produce (My Produce)

Essence: This is how you **offer your produce to buyers** on the platform. By creating a listing (variety, quantity, grade, location, expected ready date), you make your crop visible to buyers so they can place orders. Approval by a lead farmer keeps quality and details consistent, and once approved your listing can receive orders straight away—including **advance orders** before the ready date, so you can secure demand early.

Flow: Create listing → Pending approval → Approved (ACTIVE) or Revision requested.

1. Go to **My Produce** (sidebar).
2. Click **Add listing** (or similar).
3. Fill in:
 - **Variety** (e.g. Kenya, SPK004, Kabode)
 - **Quantity** and unit (kg)
 - **Quality grade** (A, B, or C)
 - **Expected ready date** (when produce will be at aggregation centre)
 - **Location:** county, sub-county, ward, village
 - Optional: price per kg, aggregation centre, images
4. Submit. The listing is created with status **Pending lead approval**.
5. A **lead farmer** (or staff) will approve or request changes. You get a notification.
6. If **approved**, the listing becomes **ACTIVE** and appears on the buyer marketplace (including for advance orders before the ready date).
7. If **revision requested**, open the listing, fix the details, and resubmit for approval.

You can **edit** or **delete** your own listings from **My Produce** according to status rules.

4. Managing orders from buyers (Orders)

Essence: Here you **see and manage every order** placed on your listings. You decide which orders to accept or reject, track payment and fulfilment, and follow the order through to collection or delivery. This is your sales desk: one place to respond to buyers, coordinate with aggregation centres, and ensure your produce reaches the buyer as agreed.

Flow: Buyer places order → You see it under Orders → Accept/Reject → Order moves through payment and fulfilment.

1. Go to **Orders** in the sidebar.

2. You see all orders for **your** listings (any status: placed, accepted, paid, ready for collection, delivered, etc.).
3. For new orders (**Order placed**):
 - Open an order to see buyer, quantity, price, and delivery/collection details.
 - **Accept** or **Reject** the order. If you reject, you can add a reason.
4. After you accept:
 - Buyer may pay (escrow). When produce is ready, you (or the centre) update status (e.g. **Ready for collection**).
 - Buyer (or transport) collects or receives delivery; status moves to **Collected / Delivered**.
5. Use **Filters** (e.g. by status) and **Search** to find specific orders.

Orders from **advance** listings (expected ready date in the future) appear here as soon as the buyer places the order; fulfilment happens when the produce is ready.

5. Pickup schedules (delivering to aggregation centres)

Essence: This is how you **schedule and record delivery** of your produce to an aggregation centre. By booking a slot, you get a clear time and place to bring your crop, avoid overcrowding, and get your delivery recorded. The centre can then issue a receipt and link your produce to batches for buyers—so pickup schedules connect your farm to the rest of the chain.

Flow: View schedules → Book a slot → Deliver produce → Receipt.

1. Go to **Pickup Schedules** in the sidebar.
2. You see **schedules** for aggregation centres (dates and available slots).
3. Select a schedule and **book a pickup slot** (e.g. for delivering your produce to the centre).
4. On the day, deliver produce to the centre in your slot. The centre may record **stock in** and you may get a **receipt** (view or download from the same area).
5. You can view past **pickup bookings** and receipts from this section.

6. Buyer requests / marketplace (as farmer)

Essence: This screen gives you a **market view** from the seller's side: what buyers are looking for and how other listings look. Use it to gauge demand, compare varieties and grades, and plan what to post

in **My Produce**. You do not buy here; you use it to **inform your selling** and then sell via **My Produce** and **Orders**.

7. Inputs (farm inputs)

Essence: This is the **inputs marketplace** where you **order seeds and other farm inputs** from registered input providers. You can compare products and prices, place orders, and track them in one place—so you can source quality inputs for the next season without leaving the platform.

1. Go to **Inputs** (or **Marketplace** → **Inputs**).
2. Browse **inputs** (e.g. seeds, inputs) offered by **input providers**.
3. Add items to cart and place an **order**.
4. Track your **input orders** from the same area or the link provided after ordering.

8. Analytics

Essence: Analytics gives you a **clear picture of your sales and activity**: how much you've sold, which varieties and grades perform best, and how your listings and orders behave over time. Use it to see what's working, plan production, and improve how you use the platform.

1. Go to **Analytics** in the sidebar.
2. View summaries of your **sales, orders, listings, and activity** (e.g. over time, by variety or grade).
3. Use filters (e.g. date range) if available to focus on a period.

9. Notifications and profile

- **Notifications** (bell icon or in-app) show approvals, new orders, revision requests, and other updates. Open them to go to the relevant screen.
- Use **Settings** or **Profile** (if available in the header) to update your details, location, or password.

10. Quick reference: key flows

Goal	Steps
Sell produce	My Produce → Add listing → Submit → Wait for approval → Orders appear when buyers order
Handle an order	Orders → Open order → Accept or Reject → Fulfil when ready (e.g. ready for collection)
Deliver to centre	Pickup Schedules → Book slot → Deliver on day → View receipt
Buy inputs	Inputs → Browse → Order → Track in input orders
See performance	Analytics → View metrics and charts

For **lead farmer** responsibilities (approving other farmers' listings), see [User Guide: Lead Farmer](#).